

User Documentation

Welcome to the **Automated Thematic Analysis** project! This system automates qualitative coding of interview transcripts: it extracts grounded codes and themes with an LLM, lets you review and adjust them, and then applies the resulting codebook back onto your transcripts so you can explore frequency, coverage, and demographic breakdowns.

Getting Started

The platform is used through the Flask web UI. Every action is scoped to a **Corpus** — a named collection of transcripts (a single default workspace corpus is created for you automatically, or you can create additional ones from the corpus selector on the Uploads page). You can also spin off a new corpus from an existing one by selecting a subset of transcripts on the Transcripts list page and using "Create New Corpus" — handy for narrowing a large corpus down before generating a codebook.

Accessing the Platform

- Web UI: <http://localhost:3000>
- API Server & Endpoints: <http://localhost:8000>
- Interactive API Docs (Swagger): <http://localhost:8000/docs>

Core Features

1. Upload

The Uploads page hosts three side-by-side entry points for one corpus:

- **Transcripts** — .jsonl interview files. Each file becomes one transcript (a .jsonl file is split into one transcript per participant username).
- **Codebook (CSV)** — a predefined hierarchy of themes/subthemes/codes; see [csv-codebook-standard.md](#) for the exact format. Uploading opens a review editor where you can rename, reparent, or delete nodes before saving.
- **Demographic data (CSV)** — one row per participant (matched to transcripts by participant name), used later to break theme results down by demographic group. Demographic uploads are staged as a preview first; you explicitly confirm or discard before anything is saved. If a demographic row's participant name doesn't automatically match a transcript title, you can link them manually on the **Linking** board.

2. Codebook Creation

A **Codebook** is the hierarchy of themes, subthemes, and codes you'll apply to your transcripts. You get to it via **Codebooks** -> **New Codebook**, which offers three modes:

- **Fully automatic** — the LLM extracts quote-grounded codes from your transcripts, consolidates and synthesizes them into themes, iteratively reviews itself against held-out transcripts, and (by default) immediately applies the finished codebook to all documents. You only provide a name and, optionally, a research question or topics of interest to steer it.
- **Semi-automatic** — same LLM generation, but you land on a review editor afterward to adjust the result before saving.
- **Manual / CSV upload** — bring your own codebook via the CSV format above, or build one from scratch in the review editor.

Generation runs as a background job with a live progress page; you can cancel it while it's running.

3. Applying a Codebook (Analysis)

Applying a codebook means running deductive LLM coding: taking an existing codebook and tagging which themes/codes are present in selected (or all) transcripts, with an exact supporting quote for every tag. This is done from the **Analysis** page ("Trigger Analysis"): pick a codebook and the transcripts to run it against, then submit. Each run is saved as an **application run** so you can revisit, export, or delete it later, and re-apply the same codebook to new transcripts without regenerating it.

4. Exploring Results

- **Theme Browser (Codebooks -> a codebook -> Themes)**: a frequency table (occurrence count + interview coverage %), the theme/code hierarchy tree, and a details panel showing supporting quotes and a demographic breakdown for the selected theme. You can switch which application run's results are shown.
- **Read Transcript (Transcripts -> a transcript -> Read)**: the full transcript text with speaker turns highlighted; open it from a specific application run to also see exactly which spans were tagged with which theme/code.
- **Export**: download a codebook's structure as CSV from the theme browser, or export one or more application runs' coded results as CSV (theme-based or participant-based shape) from the Analysis page.

Example Workflow

1. **Setup:** Ensure an LLM provider API key is configured (see [Build & Deploy](#)); pick the active provider from the home page.

Automated Thematic Analysis

Researcher workspace for corpus ingestion and thematic coding.

LLM Provider ⓘ

Select the provider used whenever you run an AI task. "FAU NHR" is the default.

Provider

FAU NHR (default) ▾

FAU NHR (default)

Academic Cloud

Save provider

and uses the setup the te
e this to route AI tasks t

Transcripts

View and upload your interview documents.

View transcripts

Demographic Data

Upload and view demographic data for interviews.

View data

2. **Upload:** Go to Uploads, create or select a corpus, and add your transcript files (and, optionally, demographic data).



Upload Interview Transcripts

Multiple files · .docx · .jsonl · .pdf · .txt · Max 10 MB each

Select files

Browse...

No files selected.

Upload Transcripts



Upload Demographic Data (optional)

Single CSV · Required column username + at least one demographic field · Preview before saving

Demographic CSV

Browse...

No file selected.

Import name (optional)

Defaults to the uploaded filename

Upload & preview



Upload Codebook (optional)

Single CSV · Required columns node type, name and description · Max 10 MB · Preview and rename before saving

Codebook CSV

Browse...

No file selected.

Upload & preview

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3. **Generate or upload a codebook:** Use **New Codebook** for LLM generation, or upload a CSV codebook.

Name Your Codebook

Mode: **Fully automatic** · LLM Provider: **FAU NHR**

Codebook name *

Required.

Optionally guide the AI below. Leave both blank to let it generate the codebook fully automatically.

Research question (optional)

e.g. How do participants experience remote work? What challenges do they face?

If provided, the AI focuses on themes relevant to this question. Use at least 10 characters.

0 / 500

Topics to focus on (optional)

e.g. isolation, productivity, work-life balance

Specific themes you want the AI to look for, even if subtle — comma-separated.

0 / 500

Max refinement iterations

5

More iterations can improve codebook quality but use more tokens. The system always enforces a safety maximum of 10 regardless of this setting.

Number of transcripts to use (optional)

e.g. 20

This corpus has 60 transcripts available. Leave blank to use all transcripts. If set, that many transcripts are chosen at random from the corpus to reduce token usage. To use specific transcripts instead, create a new corpus containing only those transcripts.

Back

Generate codebook

4. **Apply it:** Go to **Analysis**, select the codebook and transcripts, and trigger the run (skip this if you used "Fully automatic," which already applied it).
5. **Review:** Explore the Theme Browser for frequencies and quotes, use Read Transcript to trace individual coded spans back to the source text, and export results when

you're ready to share them.

Themes

Ordered by frequency. Click a row to select a theme; rows with a chevron expand to show their sub-themes, also ordered by frequency.

THEME	OCCURRENCES	INTERVIEW COVERAGE
▼ Economic Precarity Driving AI Adoption Decisions	60	100.00%
▶ Perceived Threat of AI-Driven Job Displacement	55	91.67%
▶ Financial Pressures and Motivations for Skill Development	54	90.00%
▼ Ethical Governance and Societal Impact of AI	55	91.67%
▶ Policy Measures for Transparent and Safe AI	54	90.00%
▶ Broad Ethical, Environmental, and Social Risks of AI	21	35.00%
▼ AI as Assistive Tool for Skill Growth	54	90.00%
▶ AI Supporting Routine Tasks and Idea Generation	50	83.33%
▶ Need for Upskilling and Supportive Training	35	58.33%
▶ Psychosocial Effects of AI Adoption	45	75.00%
▶ Synthesized Themes from Grounded Codes	11	18.33%
▶ Beliefs About Physical Jobs Resisting Automation	9	15.00%

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